

Data Visualization and Storytelling applied to a specific case

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

- 1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online
- 2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.
- 3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia
- 4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Data visualization

It is an interdisciplinary field that deals with the graphic representation of data.

It is a particularly efficient way of **communicating**

This representation can be considered as a **mapping** between the original data (usually numerical) and graphic elements (for example, lines or points in a chart).

The mapping determines how the attributes of these elements vary according to the data.

Ref.: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Data_visualization

Data storytelling

Data storytelling is a structured approach for communicating data insights, and it involves a combination of three key elements: ¹

1. Data (explore)
2. Visuals (assessment and selection)
3. Narrative (explain)

It is an essential Data Science skill everyone needs.

¹ Brent Dykes, Contributor, Forbes

Data storytelling

"The ability to take data, to be able to understand it, to process it, to extract value from it, to visualize it, to communicate it's going to be a hugely important skill in the next decades."

Google's Chief Economist Dr. Hal R Varian

A compelling storytelling helps to improve the communication of compelling insights and enrich insight-to-value conversion rate, and thus promote and instill a call-to-action and change.

Data storytelling Best Practices

1. Data exploration
 - Understand the context

2. Focus attention
 - Appropriate visual (human-friendly type chart)
 - Strategic use of colours (Marketing psychology)
 - Minimalist design
 - Clutter identification and removal

Data storytelling Best Practices – cont'd

3. Data explanation

- Tell a story
 - Craft narrative
 - Plot: define the essential context
 - Twists: what is interesting about the data and what it shows
 - Call to actions (embedded)
 - Ending: Define clear key takeaways, what do you want your audience to do next (decision-making, reporting, performance)

Storytelling Best Practices

- MUST have a pre-defined goal to achieve
- MUST have a clear message to deliver to your audience
- MUST be tailored to your target audience
- MUST include:
 - Introduction (first page)
 - Development (3-5 pages)
 - Conclusion (last page):
 - a. Findings
 - b. Recommendations
 - c. Call-to-action
- 5-7 page long
- 1 dashboard or worksheet per page
- 2-3 objects (text tables and charts) per dashboard
- Smart use of parameters, calculated fields and filters
- Smart use of format, colours, size, display

Get Ready

- Rehearse
- Get feedback
- Fix
- Deliver

Advice

When you tell a story, you have **ONLY** one opportunity so make it count!

The Pitch

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The Pitch

The goal of the pitch is to stimulate the interest, not to close a deal.

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The Pitch

- **Know your audience**
 - What is **important to your audience**?
 - What are the **three most important** things you would like to learn about our organization?
 - Are there any special issues, questions, or **landmines** I should be prepared for in the meeting?
 - Know your organization's background (**vision, mission, goals**)
 - Know current undertakings
- **Observe the 10/20/30 Rule**

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The Pitch – cont'd

- **Observe the 10/20/30 Rule**
 1. 10 slides
 2. 20 minutes
 3. 30-point-size text

Next Steps

Always end your presentation with a call to action such as a request for decision-making, a trial period or a test installation.

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The Pitch: tips

- It is a brief presentation of no more than 20 slides (ideally 10) that concentrates in the absolute essentials.
- Communicate enough to get to the next step, not everything.
- 20 minutes leave you enough time for discussion.
- Set the stage
- Let one person do the talking
- Catalyze fantasy
- Get to 1,000 feet and stay there (not beyond, not beneath)
- Define next steps
- Shut up, take notes, summarize, regurgitate and follow-up

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Pitch: about the presentation.

- Use a dark background, add your logo to the master page,
- Use common, sans serif fonts
- Animate your body, not your slides
- Build bullets and Use only one level of bullets
- Add diagrams and graphs
- Make printable slides
- Prepare a short presentation with a memorable, compelling story of how you solve a real pain
- Do not send your presentation in advance to the meeting
- Try not hand your presentation at the start unless requested

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Pitch, then plan.

- A good business case is a detailed version of a pitch and not the reverse.

The process:

- Throw together a pitch that contains the 10 slides
- Try it out on some mentors, colleagues, investors, coaches
- Get the team in a room and discussed lessons learned
- Fix the pitch
- Start writing the business case

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Pitch, then plan – cont'd

- The pitch is more important than the business plan.
- It will determine whether you are rejected or generate further interest.
- It is easier to fix.
- You won't get feedback on your business case/plan. It may never be read.
- Focus on the Executive Summary of the pitch as they are the framework for your business case/plan.

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Technical Pitch

Slides	Content
Title	Organization Name, your name, and title, and contact information.
Problem	Describe the pain you are alleviating. The goal is to get everyone nodding and buying in.
Solution	Explain how you alleviate the pain and the meaning that you make. Ensure that the audience clearly understands what you sell and your value proposition.
Technology	Describe in detail the technology, secret sauce, or magic behind your product or service. Present a SWOT analysis re the different technologies available and your recommendations
Proof of Concept / Demo	Deliver a Proof of concept (PoC) to demonstrate its feasibility or a demo in principle with the aim of verifying that some concept or theory has practical potential.
Cost/Benefit analysis	Provide details of costs and the benefits (tangible and intangible) of adopting the recommended solution.
Management Team	Describe the key players of your management team board of directors, and board of advisor, major investors.

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